

Data Visualization Pitch

TOURISM AND CULTURE IN EUROPE: TRENDS AND COUNTRY COMPARISONS (2015–2024)

Student name: Rishpa Shrestha

Student ID: 947788

Student e-mail address: r.shrestha1@campus.unimib.it



RESEARCH QUESTION



How has tourism activity changed over time in selected European countries?

Secondary Research Question

Which European countries have the highest tourism activity?

How did the COVID-19 pandemic affect tourism trends?

What differences can we see between Southern and Northern European countries regarding tourism intensity?

ABOUT DATA

➔ **DATASET:**
NIGHTS SPENT AT TOURIST ACCOMMODATION
ESTABLISHMENTS (TOUR_OCC_NINAT)

➔ **SOURCE:**
EUROSTAT (STATISTICAL OFFICE OF THE
EUROPEAN UNION) DATASET LINK: [CLICK HERE](#)
SOURCE LINK: [CLICK HERE](#)

➔ **SCOPE OF ANALYSIS:**

- COUNTRIES: GERMANY, FRANCE, ITALY, SPAIN, GREECE, NETHERLANDS, AUSTRIA
- TIME PERIOD: 2015–2024
- MEASURE: NUMBER OF NIGHTS SPENT (ANNUAL)

➔ **WHY THIS DATASET:**
THIS DATASET CAPTURES TOURISM INTENSITY AND CULTURAL TRAVEL BEHAVIOR MORE ACCURATELY THAN VISITOR COUNTS, SINCE IT REFLECTS THE LENGTH OF STAY.

➔ **DATA QUALITY & PREPARATION:**
THE RAW EXPORT INCLUDED METADATA ROWS AND ESTIMATED FLAGS. CLEANING WAS PERFORMED IN APPLE NUMBERS (MACOS) BY REMOVING METADATA, DELETING EMPTY COLUMNS, AND ENSURING ALL VALUES WERE NUMERIC.

➔ **LICENSE / REUSE:**
EUROSTAT DATA IS PUBLICLY AVAILABLE AND REUSABLE WITH ATTRIBUTION UNDER OPEN DATA TERMS.

Data source & selection

- Dataset: Nights spent at tourist accommodation establishments (tour_occ_ninat)
- Source: Eurostat (Statistical Office of the European Union)
- Scope: Germany, France, Italy, Spain, Greece, Netherlands, Austria (2015–2024)
- Unit: Number of nights spent (annual)

Data cleaning & preparation

- Exported data from Eurostat as .xlsx
- Cleaned using Apple Numbers (macOS):
- removed metadata/notes rows
- removed empty columns created during export
- ensured values were numeric and consistent
- created two subsets:
 - a. full time series (2015–2024)
 - b. comparison years (2019 vs 2024) + 2024-only table for mapping

Visualization tools used

- Datawrapper → Line chart (tourism trends 2015–2024)
- Flourish → Slope chart (tourism recovery 2019 vs 2024)
- Tableau Public → Filled map (tourism intensity by country in 2024)

AI tools declaration

ChatGPT and Google Gemini were used to refine slide text, structure the methodology, and improve interpretation clarity.

Reproducibility

Cleaned dataset + processing steps available here: [Click Here](#)



METHODOLOGY

Insights from the data

Growth before COVID (2015–2019):

Tourism increased steadily, reflecting strong demand for leisure and cultural travel in Europe.

COVID shock (2020):

The sharp drop is linked to travel bans, lockdowns, and reduced mobility across all countries.

Recovery pattern (2021–2024):

Recovery is uneven but strong, suggesting tourism resilience and reopening policies.

Why Southern Europe dominates:

Spain, Italy, and France consistently lead due to:

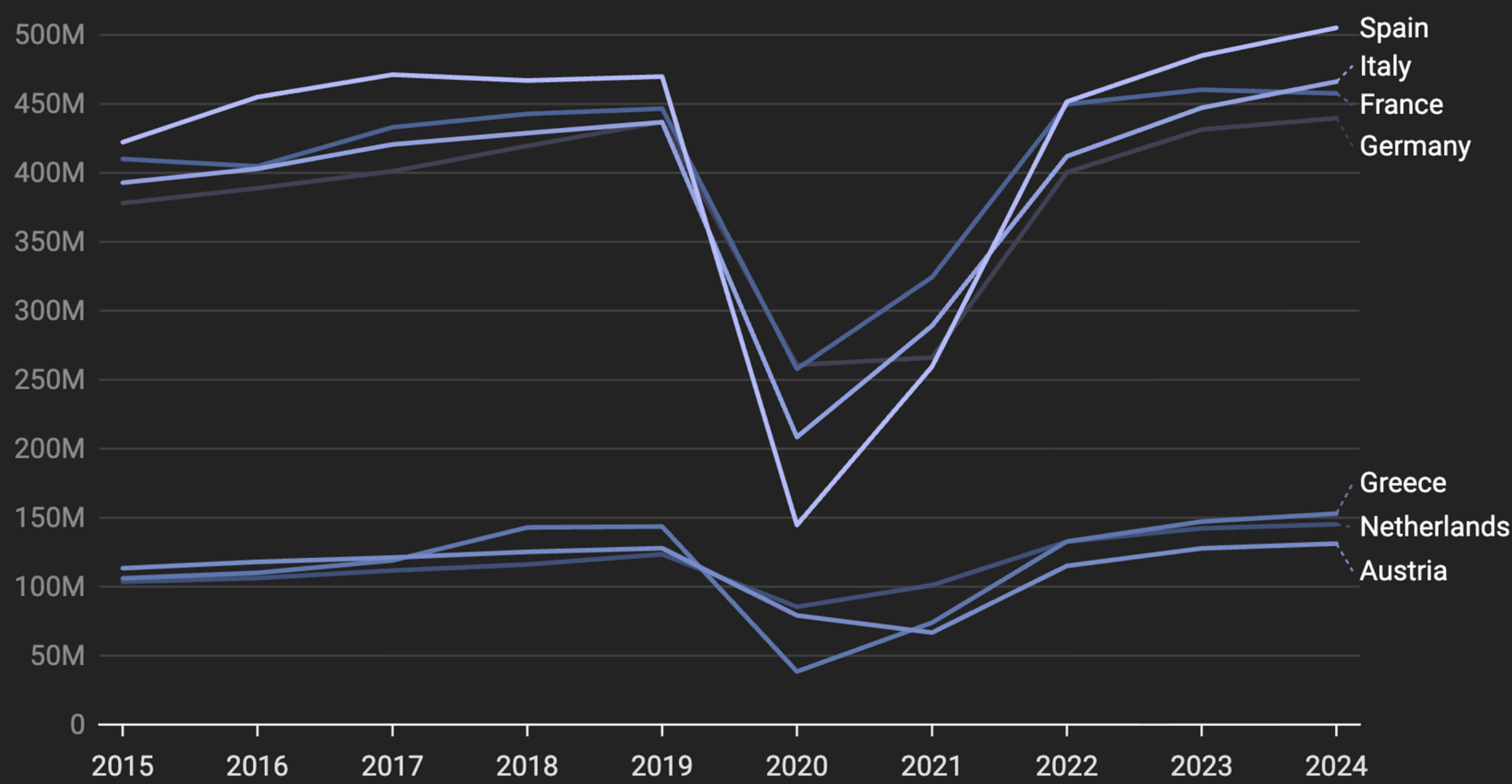
1. globally recognized cultural heritage and city tourism
2. coastal leisure tourism + climate advantage
3. large accommodation capacity and established tourism infrastructure

Long-term implication:

Post-pandemic tourism appears to rebound strongly, but countries dependent on international tourism remain more exposed to global crises.

DATA VISUALIZATION 1 (Datawrapper).

Tourism Trends in Selected European Countries (2015–2024)



This line chart shows tourism activity measured by nights spent in accommodation establishments. All countries show growth until 2019, a sharp decline in 2020 due to COVID-19 restrictions, and a strong recovery by 2024, with Spain, Italy, and France remaining top destinations.

Source:
Eurostat(tour_occ_ninat)

Interactive chart: [Click Here](#)



DATA VISUALIZATION 2 (Flourish).

Tourism Recovery After COVID: 2019 vs 2024

Nights spent at tourist accommodation establishments

Country Germany Greece Spain France Italy Netherlands Austria



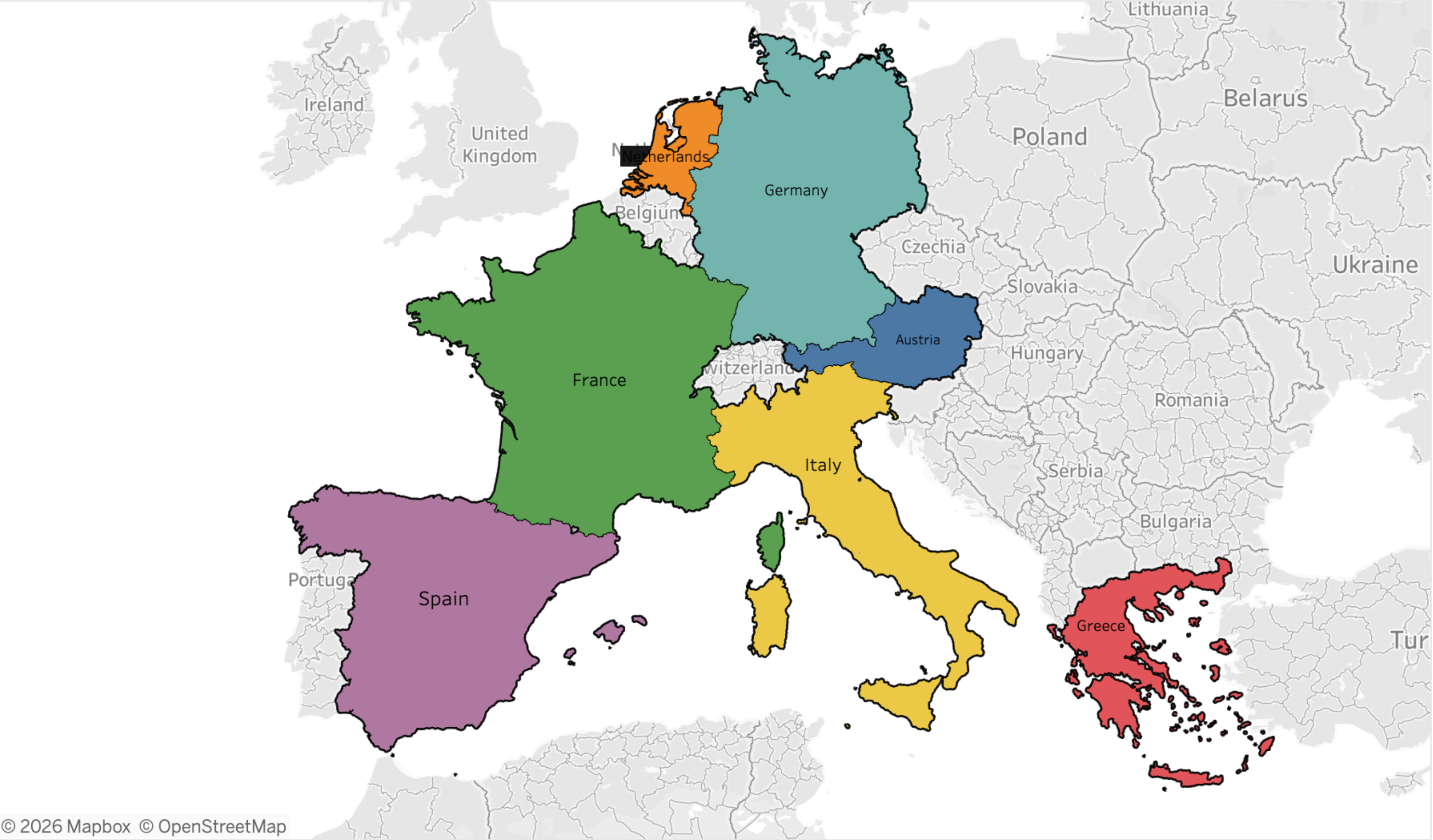
This slope chart compares tourism activity before the pandemic (2019) and after recovery (2024). All selected countries show an increase, indicating resilience in tourism demand. Southern European destinations remain dominant, reflecting the importance of cultural and leisure tourism.

Source:
Eurostat (tour_occ_ninat)

Interactive chart: [Click Here](#)

DATA VISUALIZATION 3 (Tableau)

Tourism Intensity Across Europe (2024)



Nights2024

- 131,201,233
- 145,237,994
- 152,944,662
- 439,619,668
- 457,644,262
- 466,158,045
- 505,166,012

This map visualizes tourism intensity across selected European countries in 2024. Spain, Italy, and France show the highest levels of nights spent, supporting the trend that cultural heritage and leisure tourism contribute strongly to Southern Europe's dominance.

Source:
Eurostat (tour_occ_ninat)

Interactive map:
[Click Here](#)

CONCLUSION

01

Tourism activity grew steadily across the selected European countries from 2015 to 2019.

02

The COVID-19 pandemic caused a major disruption in 2020, visible as a sharp decline in nights spent.

03

By 2024, tourism shows strong recovery, confirming the resilience of cultural and leisure travel demand.

04

Spain, Italy, and France remain the leading destinations, highlighting Southern Europe's dominance driven by cultural heritage, climate, and established tourism infrastructure.

LICENSE

“Tourism and Culture in Europe: Trends and Country Comparisons (2015–2024)”
by Rishpa Shrestha
is licensed under
Creative Commons Attribution–ShareAlike 4.0 International License (CC BY–SA 4.0).
<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/>